

AWS Cloud Security › Penetration Testing

Penetration Testing

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AWS Customer Support Policy for Penetration Testing

AWS customers are welcome to carry out security assessments or penetration tests of their AWS infrastructure without prior approval for the services listed in the next section under "Permitted Services." Additionally, AWS permits customers to host their security assessment tooling within the AWS IP space or other cloud provider for on-prem, in AWS, or third party contracted testing. All security testing that includes Command and Control (C2) requires prior approval.

Please ensure that these activities are aligned with the policy set out below. Note: Customers are not permitted to conduct any security assessments of AWS infrastructure or the AWS services themselves. If you discover a security issue within any of the AWS services observed in your security assessment, please [contact AWS Security](#) immediately.

If AWS receives an abuse report for activities related to your security testing, we will forward it to you. When responding, please provide us with approved language detailing your use case, including a point of contact that we can share with any third party reporters. Learn more [here](#).

Resellers of AWS services are responsible for their customers' security testing activity.

Customer Service Policy for Penetration Testing

Permitted Services

- Amazon EC2 instances, WAF, NAT Gateways, and Elastic Load Balancers
- Amazon RDS
- Amazon CloudFront
- Amazon Aurora
- Amazon API Gateways
- AWS AppSync
- AWS Lambda and Lambda Edge functions
- Amazon Lightsail resources
- Amazon Elastic Beanstalk environments
- Amazon Elastic Container Service
- AWS Fargate
- Amazon OpenSearch Service
- Amazon FSx
- Amazon Transit Gateway

Customers seeking to test non approved services will need to work directly with AWS Support or your account representative.

Prohibited Activities

Customers seeking to test non approved services will need to work directly with AWS Support or your account representative.

- DNS zone walking via Amazon Route 53 Hosted Zones
- DNS hijacking via Route 53
- DNS Pharming via Route 53
- Denial of Service (DoS), Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS),
- Simulated DoS, Simulated DDoS (These are subject to the [DDoS Simulation Testing policy](#))
- Port flooding
- Protocol flooding
- Request flooding (login request flooding, API request flooding)
- S3 bucket takeover
- Subdomain Takeover

Prohibited Services for Outbound Penetration Testing

- Amazon API Gateway
- Amazon Bedrock AgentCore

Other

Simulated6

Events

Other Simulated Events

Open all

Red/Blue/Purple Team Testing

Volumetric Testing

Simulated Phishing**Malware Testing****Requesting Authorization for Other Simulated Events****Testing Conclusion**

Terms and Conditions

All Security Testing must be in line with these AWS Security Testing Terms and Conditions.

Security Testing:

- Will be limited to the services, network bandwidth, requests per minute, and instance type.
- Is subject to the terms of the [Amazon Web Services Customer Agreement](#) between you and AWS
- Will abide by AWS's policy regarding the use of security assessment tools and services, included in the next section

Any discoveries of vulnerabilities or other issues that are the direct result of AWS's tools or services must be conveyed to [AWS Security](#) within 24 hours of completion of testing.



AWS Policy Regarding the Use of Security Assessment Tools and Services

AWS's policy regarding the use of security assessment tools and services allows significant flexibility for performing security assessments of your AWS assets while protecting other AWS customers and ensuring quality-of-service across AWS.

AWS understands there are a variety of public, private, commercial, and/or open-source tools and services to choose from for the purposes of performing a security assessment of your AWS assets.

The term "security assessment" refers to all activity engaged in for the purposes of determining the efficacy or existence of security controls amongst your AWS assets, e.g., port-scanning, vulnerability scanning/checks, penetration testing, exploitation, web application scanning, as well as any injection, forgery, or fuzzing activity, either performed remotely against your AWS assets, amongst/between your AWS assets, or locally within the virtualized assets themselves.

You are NOT limited in your selection of tools or services to perform a security assessment of your AWS assets. However, you ARE prohibited from utilizing any tools or services in a manner that perform Denial-of-Service (DoS) attacks or simulations of such against ANY AWS asset, yours or otherwise. Customers wishing to perform a DDoS simulation test should review our [DDoS Simulation Testing policy](#).

A security tool that solely performs a remote query of your AWS asset to determine a software name and version, such as "banner grabbing," for the purpose of comparison to a list of versions known to be vulnerable to DoS, is NOT in violation of this policy.

Additionally, a security tool or service that solely crashes a running process on your AWS asset, temporary or otherwise, as necessary for remote or local exploitation as part of the security assessment, is NOT in violation of this policy. However, this tool may NOT engage in protocol flooding or resource request flooding, as mentioned above.

A security tool or service that creates, determines the existence of, or demonstrates a DoS condition in ANY other manner, actual or simulated, is expressly forbidden.

Some tools or services include actual DoS capabilities as described, either silently/inherently if used inappropriately or as an explicit test/check or feature of the tool or service. Any security tool or service that has such a DoS capability, must have the explicit ability to DISABLE, DISARM, or otherwise render HARMLESS, that DoS capability. Otherwise, that tool or service may NOT be employed for ANY facet of the security assessment.

It is the sole responsibility of the AWS customer to:
(1) ensure the tools and services employed for performing a security assessment are properly configured and successfully operate in a manner that

does not perform DoS attacks or simulations of such, and (2) independently validate that the tool or service employed does not perform DoS attacks, or simulations of such, PRIOR to security assessment of any AWS assets. This AWS customer responsibility includes ensuring contracted third-parties perform security assessments in a manner that does not violate this policy.

Furthermore, you are responsible for any damages to AWS or other AWS customers that are caused by your testing or security assessment activities.

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